

Introversion and extroversion

Whether teens prefer hustle and bustle or peace and quiet, small groups or large, knowing their preferences empowers them to make their way in the world—on their own terms.

Temperaments and traits

One way to think about people's personalities is whether they're introverts (people who tend to focus on the internal world) or extroverts (people who prefer the external world). Whether a person is one or the other is based on how much social interaction they feel comfortable with. Introverted people typically prefer socializing one-on-one or with smaller groups of people, and feel the need for some time alone to recharge after social situations. People who are extroverted feel energized and stimulated by big groups, as well as new people and situations.

Introversion and extroversion are two extremes, and the complexity of personalities means that while some people identify simply as one or the other, many others are a mix of the two. This type of mixture is known as ambiversion.

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"The secret to life is to put yourself in the right lighting. For some, it's a Broadway spotlight; for others, a lamplit desk."

Susan Cain, author



Introversion

Introverted people enjoy quiet settings with limited stimuli. Due to these preferences, they often choose solitude and small groups. They tackle tasks deliberately and with focus, they listen more than they talk, and they think before speaking.

Ambiversion

Ambiverted people fall somewhere between introversion and extroversion. They tend to be comfortable, motivated, and enjoy interacting in social situations, but also seek out quieter settings and complete tasks thoughtfully.

Extroversion

People who are extroverted prefer hustle and bustle. They feel excited about the outer world, and are motivated by it. Extroverts tend to enjoy meeting people in large groups, take risks, and tackle life with haste and ferocity.